

CANADA VS SWITZERLAND

Data-led opposition report - statistical layer replaces arrow-based frames

MATCH LENS

Switzerland have controlled territory through pass volume, final-third receptions and repeat wide service. Canada enter with stronger World Cup pressing volume and box-entry output, but must keep the central block compact against Xhaka/Freuler and avoid long defensive spells around the box.

2.50

SUI XG

avg WC match

206

SUI FINAL 3RD REC.

avg WC match

29

SUI CROSSES

avg WC match

2.69

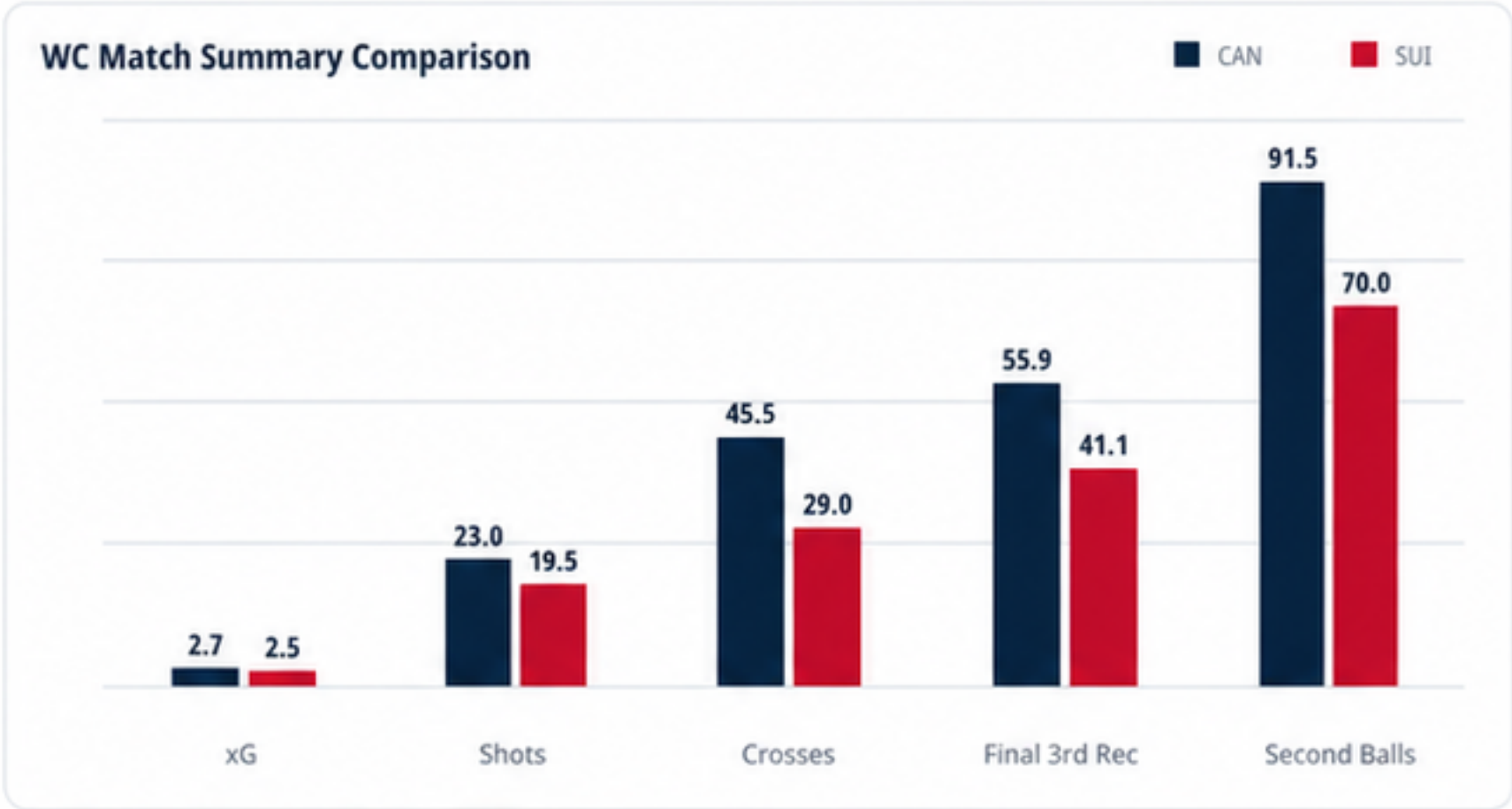
CAN XG

avg WC match

92

CAN SECOND BALLS

avg WC match



* Final-third receptions scaled /5 for chart balance.



WIDE SERVICE & BOX THREAT

Switzerland generate high-quality chances from wide areas through early service, cutbacks and second wave arrivals.

CANADA MUST BE READY FOR:

- Early crosses and far-post runs
- Cutbacks across the six-yard box
- Late arriving midfield support
- Sustained pressure in and around the box

PROJECTED LINEUPS & AVAILABILITY

Lineups based on supplied projection: Canada 4-4-2 vs Switzerland 4-2-3-1.

CANADA PROJECTED XI (4-4-2)



CANADA AVAILABILITY / TACTICAL NOTE

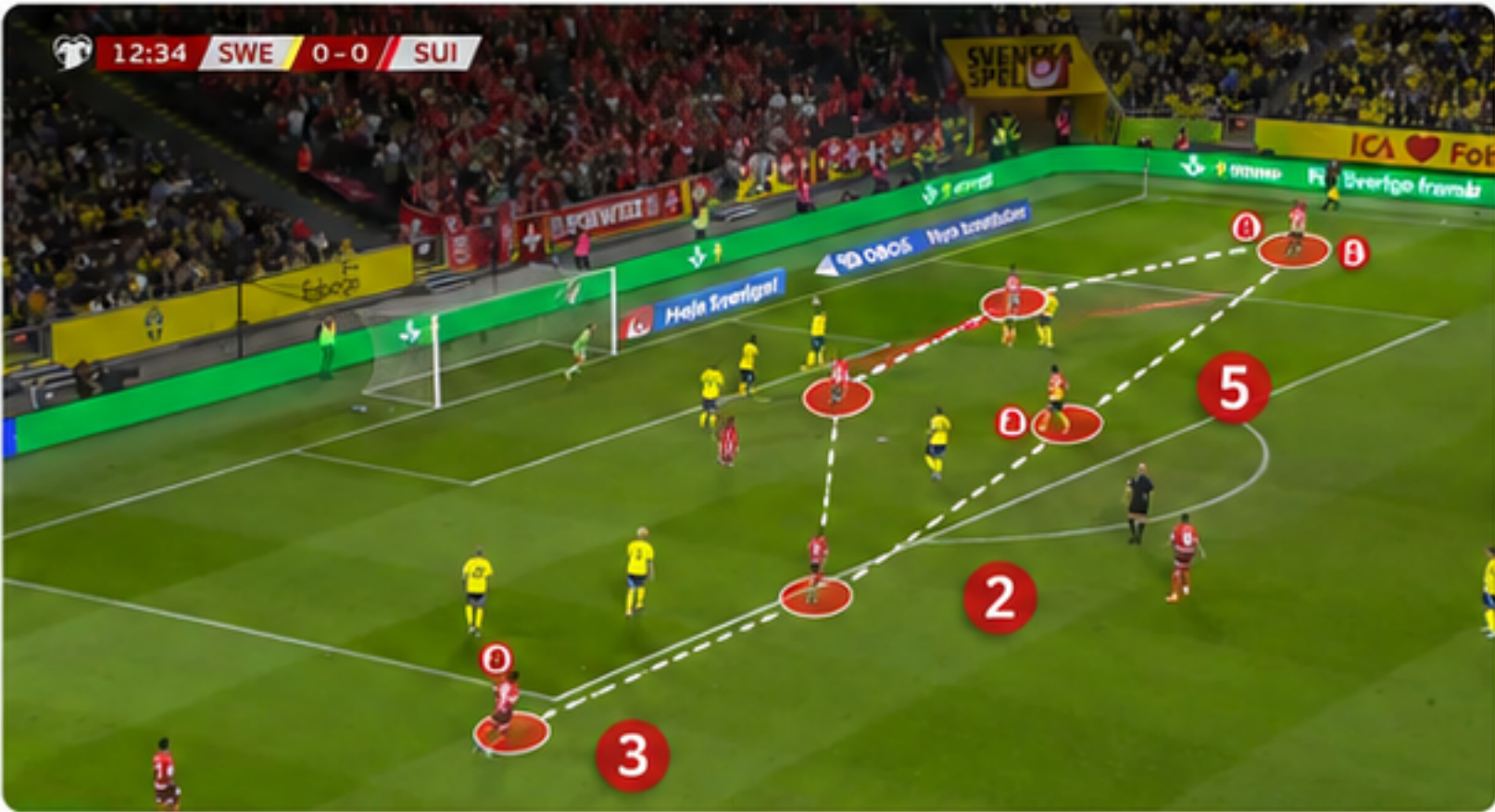
- Projected back four: Laryea - de Fougierolles - Cornelius - Johnston.
- Buchanan and Ali Ahmed provide wide running; Eustaquio/Saliba hold central access.

SWITZERLAND PROJECTED XI (4-2-3-1)



SWITZERLAND ROLE NOTE

- Xhaka/Freuler double pivot sets tempo and first progression.
- Ndoeye and Vargas are wide threats; Embolo anchors the central box presence.



SWITZERLAND SHAPE & BEHAVIOUR

From 4-2-3-1 to 2-3-5 / 3-2-5 in possession

Switzerland typically build from a 4-2-3-1 base. In possession, the shape transforms as both fullbacks provide width and the two No. 6s (Xhaka & Freuler) control circulation.

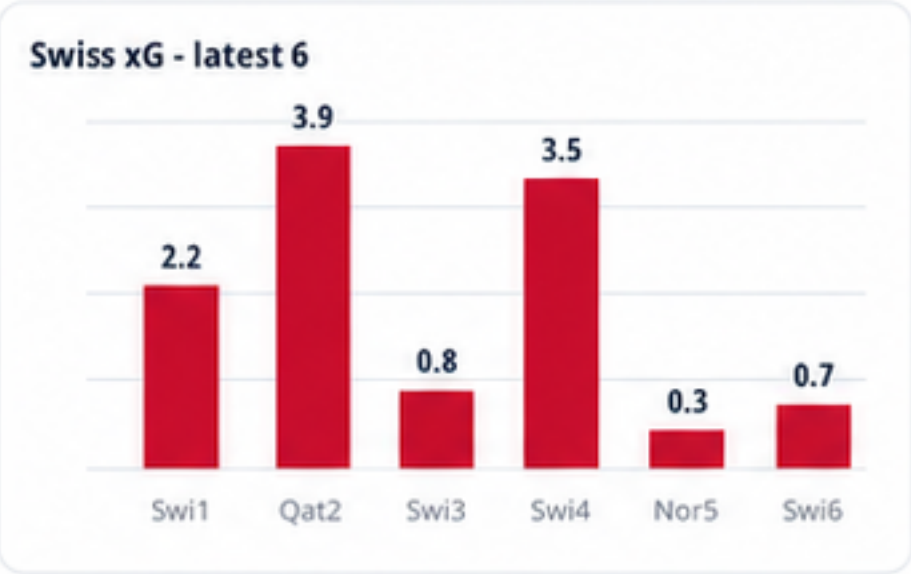
- 1 Double Pivot Control**
Xhaka and Freuler operate as the metronomes, dictating tempo and switching play through the thirds.
- 2 Midfield Overload**
The No. 10 (Manzambi) stays high between the lines while the pivots create a 3v2 in central areas.
- 3 Wide & High**
Wingbacks push high and wide while Ndoeye and Vargas stretch the field, creating a 2-3-5 or 3-2-5 attacking structure.

- KEY THREATS**
 - Quick circulation through Xhaka/Freuler.
 - High fullback positions create crossing volume.
 - Wide forwards attack the half-space and back post.
 - Transitions triggered through counters after regains.

TEAM STRUCTURE & RECENT FORM

Recent sample, formation usage and output indicators from the shared team stat file.

Date	Match	Shape	G	xG	Sh	Poss
2026-06-18	SUI - Bosnia-Herzegovina 4:1	4-4-1-1	4	2.19	13	64.5%
2026-06-13	QAT - SUI 1:1	4-3-3	1	3.90	25	67.4%
2026-06-06	SUI - Australia 1:1	4-4-2	1	0.84	8	64.0%
2026-05-31	SUI - Jordan 4:1	3-4-3	4	3.51	19	67.8%
2026-03-31	Norway - Switzerland 0:0	3-4-3	0	0.31	8	50.9%
2026-03-27	SUI - Germany 3:4	4-3-3	3	0.68	7	49.1%
2025-11-18	Kosovo - Switzerland 1:1	4-5-1	1	0.48	7	52.7%
2025-11-15	SUI - Sweden 4:1	4-3-3	4	2.16	8	59.2%
2025-10-13	Slovenia - Switzerland 0:0	4-3-3	0	0.46	10	64.4%
2025-10-10	Sweden - Switzerland 0:2	4-2-3-1	2	2.59	17	57.0%



STRUCTURE INTERPRETATION

- Last 12 sample: 60.4% possession, 588 passes, 88.8% pass completions.
- World Cup sample: 3.04 xG, 19.0 shots and 35 touches in the penalty area per match.
- Progression comes through volume: 75 passes to final third and 76 progressive passes per WC match.

10.3

PPDA

last 12

14.7

CROSSES

last 12

20.4

BOX TOUCHES

last 12

STRUCTURE: 4-3-3 IN POSSESSION

Switzerland typically build in a 4-3-3 with wingers high and the No.8s pushing into half-spaces. Fullbacks provide width to stretch the block and create crossing lanes.

REPEATED PATTERN: RIGHT-SIDE OVERLOADS

Wide overloads on the right create 2v1 or 3v2 situations to isolate the fullback. They look to combine quickly, then deliver early balls into the box.

MATCH SUMMARY DATA: SHARED REPORTS

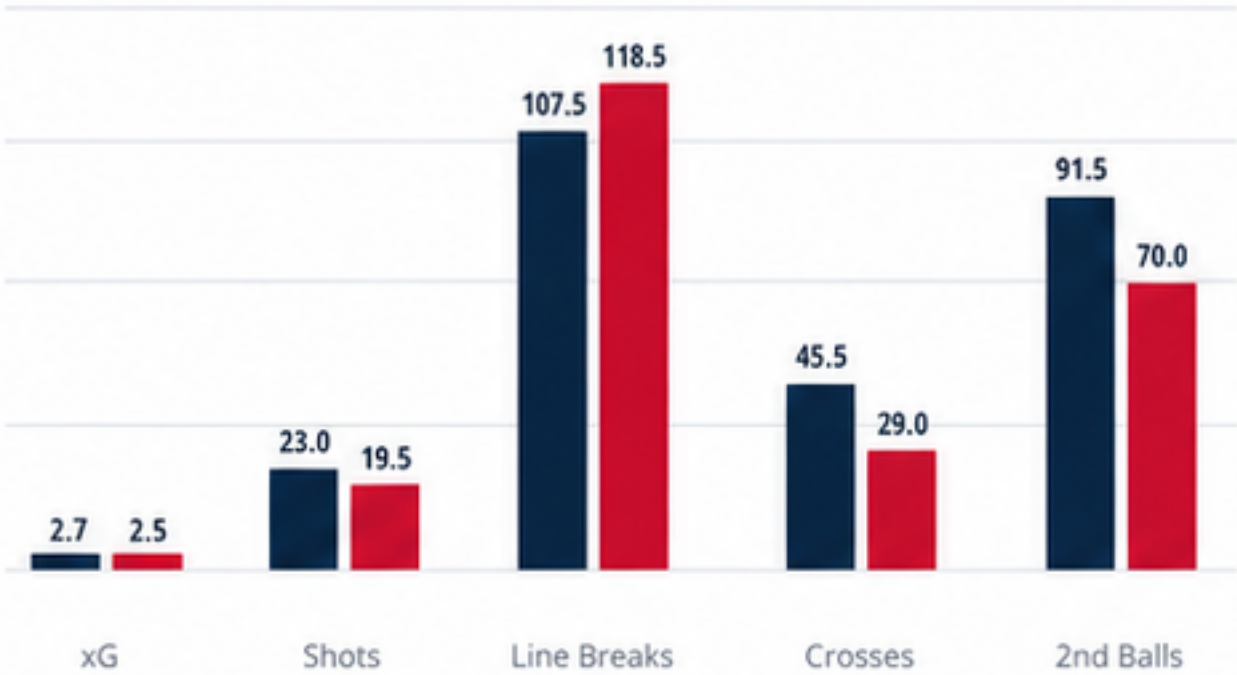
Canada and Switzerland World Cup match outputs from the supplied post-match reports.

Match	Score	xG	Shots (OT)	Pass	Pass%	Line Br.	Final 3rd Rec.	Cross	2nd Balls
CAN-QAT	6-0	3.9	33 (11)	575	93%	131	416	61	89
CAN-BIH	1-1	1.49	13 (4)	412	77%	84	143	30	94
SUI-QAT	1-1	3.14	26 (7)	591	92%	122	245	34	70
SUI-BIH	4-1	1.85	13 (7)	601	88%	115	166	24	70



Two-match average

CAN SUI



DATA READ

- Switzerland averaged 596 passes and 90% pass completion across Qatar/Bosnia.
- Canada averaged 91.5 second balls and 45.5 crosses across Bosnia/Qatar.
- Final-third reception volume is high on both sides; this match can be decided by who controls the first pass after regain.

KEY TAKEAWAY

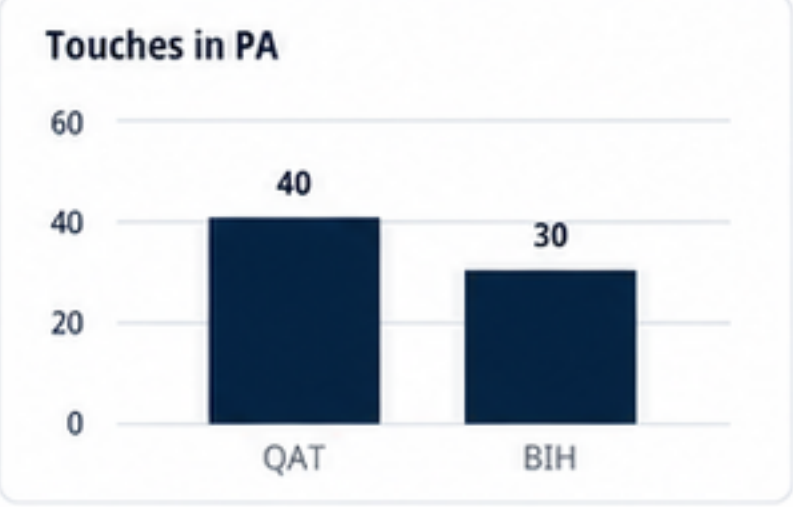
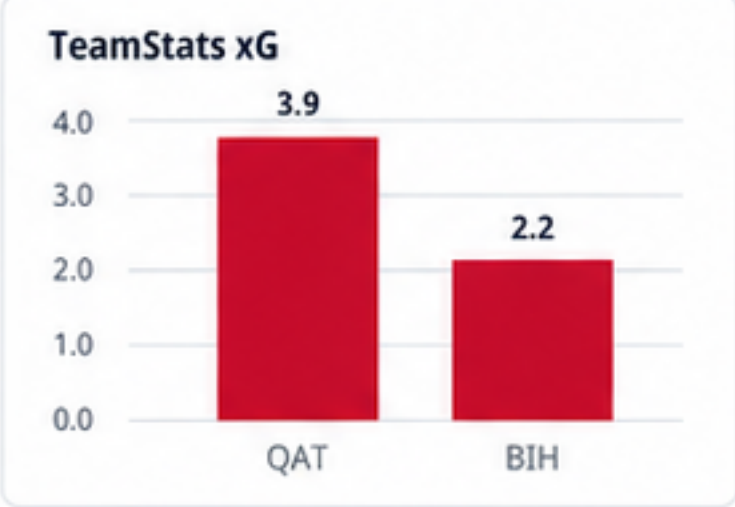


- Switzerland build games with control, create repeated entries into the final third, and punish disorganized defending on second phases.
- High pass volume and accuracy (596 passes, 90% completion) reflect a team that keeps structure and moves the ball safely.
 - They generate strong final-third volume (205 avg. entries/match) with multiple routes of access.
 - Second-phase threat is consistent: 35.0 Swiss 2nd balls per match, allowing them to sustain pressure and create scoring chances.
 - Disorganized defending after the first action leads to cutbacks, late runs and high-quality shooting situations.

SWITZERLAND ATTACKING PROFILE

Data-driven insights combined with match visuals to understand Switzerland's attacking patterns, chance creation methods and key behaviours in the final third.

Match	G	xG	Sh	SOT	Cross	Box Touch	PA Entries R/C
SUI - Bosnia-Herzegovina 4:1	4	2.19	13	8	24	30	39/8
QAT - SUI 1:1	1	3.90	25	7	19	40	35/5

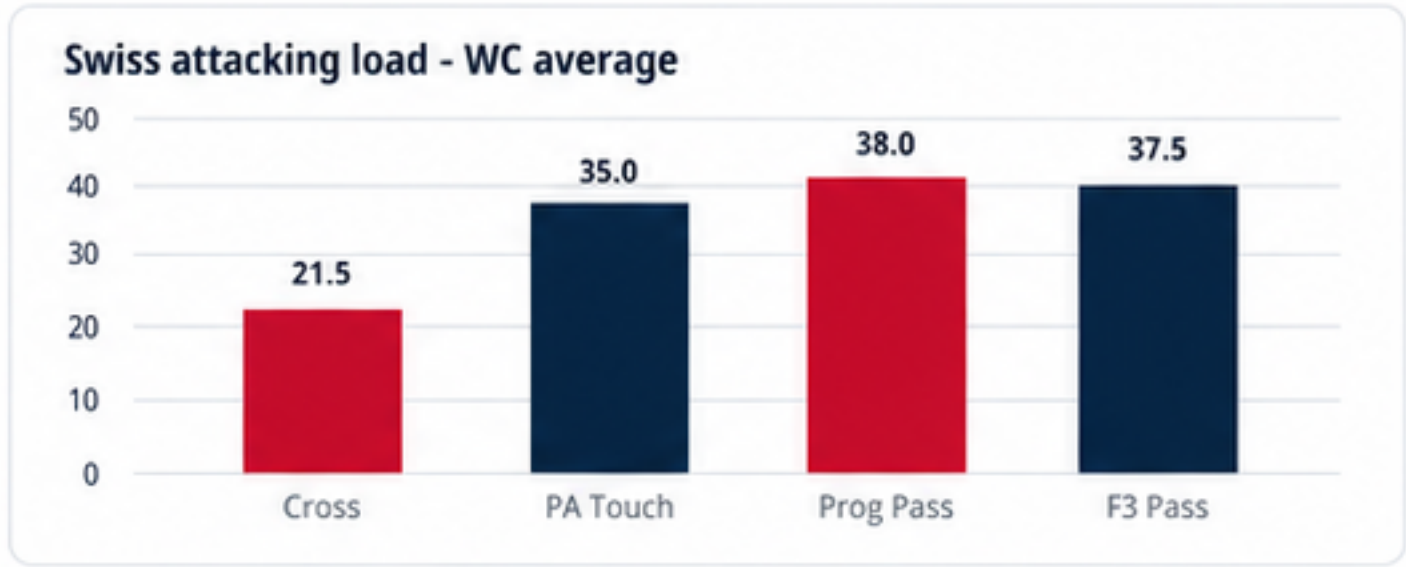


CREATION INDICATORS

- WC average: 3.04 xG and 19.0 shots per match.
- Box presence: 35 penalty-area touches and 37 run entries per match.
- Wide supply: 21.5 crosses and 11.0 deep completed passes per match.

CANADA DEFENSIVE IMPLICATION

- Do not defend only the first ball: Swiss chance volume grows through repeat entries and second actions.
- Keep Johnston/Buchanan and Laryea/Ali Ahmed connected against wide service.
- Centre-backs must handle Embolo while midfield screens Manzambi receiving behind the first line.



 **LEFT-HALF-SPACE PENETRATION**
Swiss attackers frequently receive in the left half-space and combine quickly to break lines. Early vertical passes into the channel create 1v1 or cutback opportunities.



 **CUTBACK CREATION & BOX OCCUPATION**
Once wide space is gained, Switzerland generate cutbacks across the six-yard box. Expect multiple runners arriving late for first-time finishes or second-ball shots.

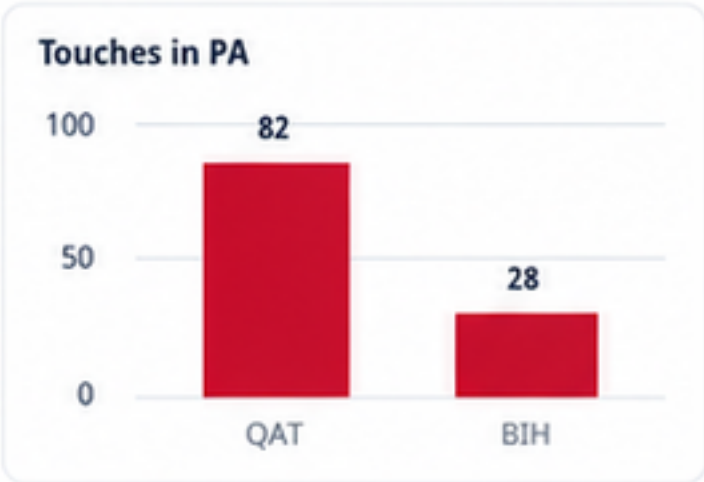
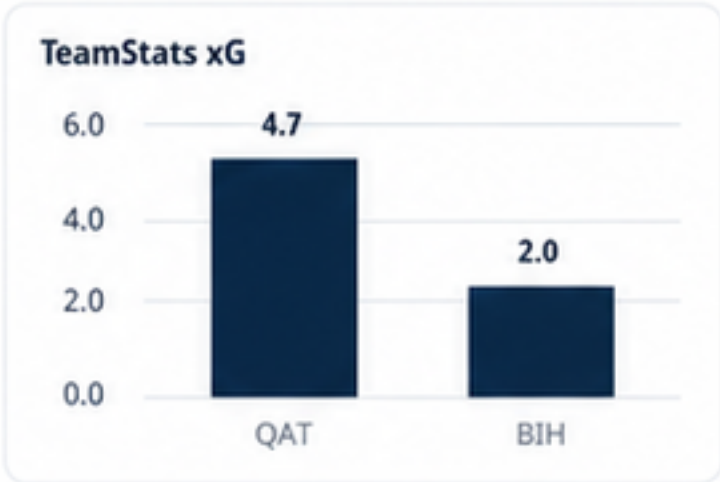


 **WIDE SERVICE & FAR-POST THREAT**
Early and deep crosses are used to target far-post runners and create knockdowns. Second actions around the penalty spot are a consistent source of shots.

CANADA ATTACKING PROFILE

Canada output from the supplied team stat and post-match files.

Match	G	xG	Sh	SOT	Cross	Box Touch	PA Entries R/C
CAN - Qatar 6:0	6	4.74	29	9	49	82	69/15
CAN - Bosnia-Herzegovina 1:1	1	2.01	13	3	25	28	31/1

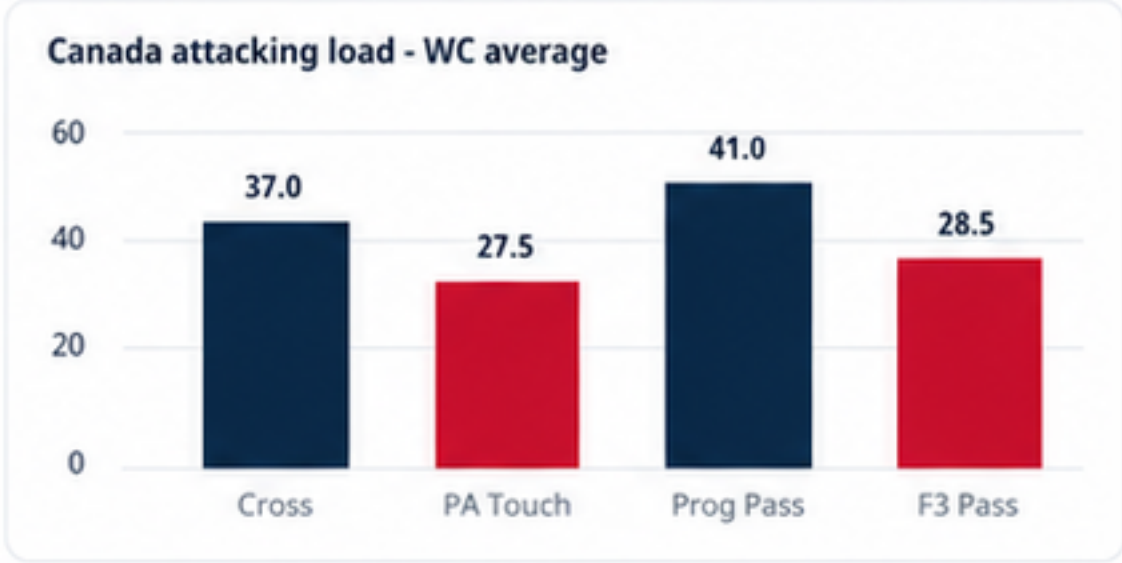


CANADA THREAT INDICATORS

- WC average: 3.38 xG and 21.0 shots per match.
- Wide volume: 37.0 crosses and 13.0 deep completed crosses per match.
- Progressive supply: 82 progressive passes and 57 passes to final third per match.

SWISS DEFENSIVE IMPLICATION

- Canada have enough wide crossing volume to stress Switzerland if the first pass after regain is secure.
- David and Larin give Canada two central targets; second-phase arrivals matter against Akanji/Elvedi.
- Buchanan/Laryea speed should be used early before the Swiss block settles.



WHERE CANADA CAN ATTACK SWITZERLAND

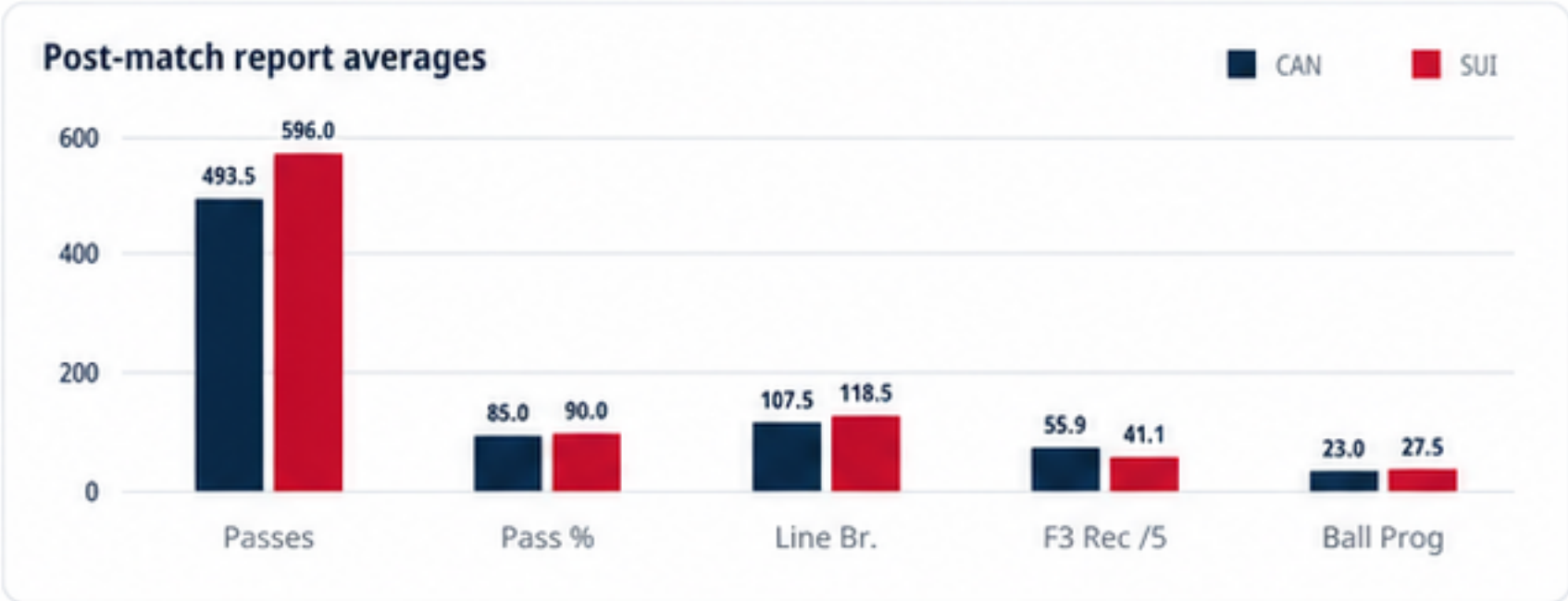
EXPLOIT SPACES AROUND THE FULL-BACKS
Switzerland's full-backs can be advanced in possession. Quick switches and early vertical passes into the half-space behind them create 1v1 and cutback opportunities.

QUICK COMBINATIONS AROUND THE BOX
Short, sharp combinations on the edge of the area can disorganise Swiss centre-backs and create shooting lanes or cutbacks for late runners.

ATTACK SECOND BALLS IN THE AREA
Switzerland commit numbers forward. Attacking second balls from crosses and cutbacks is a consistent route to high-value shots.

POSSESSION & PROGRESSION COMPARISON

Who controls the ball, breaks lines and reaches the final third.



Metric	Canada avg	Switzerland avg	Canada implication
Passes	494	596	Need selective pressure; do not chase every circulation
Pass %	85%	90%	Force play into lower-quality wide deliveries
Line breaks	107.5	118.5	Midfield screen must protect central lanes
Final-third rec.	279.5	205.5	Back line must communicate around late runners
Ball progressions	23.0	27.5	First forward pass after regain can flip pressure

PROGRESSION READ

- Switzerland average 118.5 completed line breaks in their two World Cup reports.
- Canada can answer with verticality: 91.5 second balls and 45.5 crosses per report.
- The key is not possession volume; it is the first clean forward pass after Canada wins the ball.

PATIENT CIRCULATION & SWITCHES OF PLAY

Switzerland build patiently from the back, using full-backs and the holding midfielders to switch play and find space in the half-spaces or wide channels.

MIDFIELD CONTROL & PROGRESSION TO WIDE ZONES

Xhaka and Freuler dictate tempo and receive between the lines, then progress the ball into wide or half-space zones to advance into the final third.

90%
SWISS PASS COMPLETION
PMSR avg

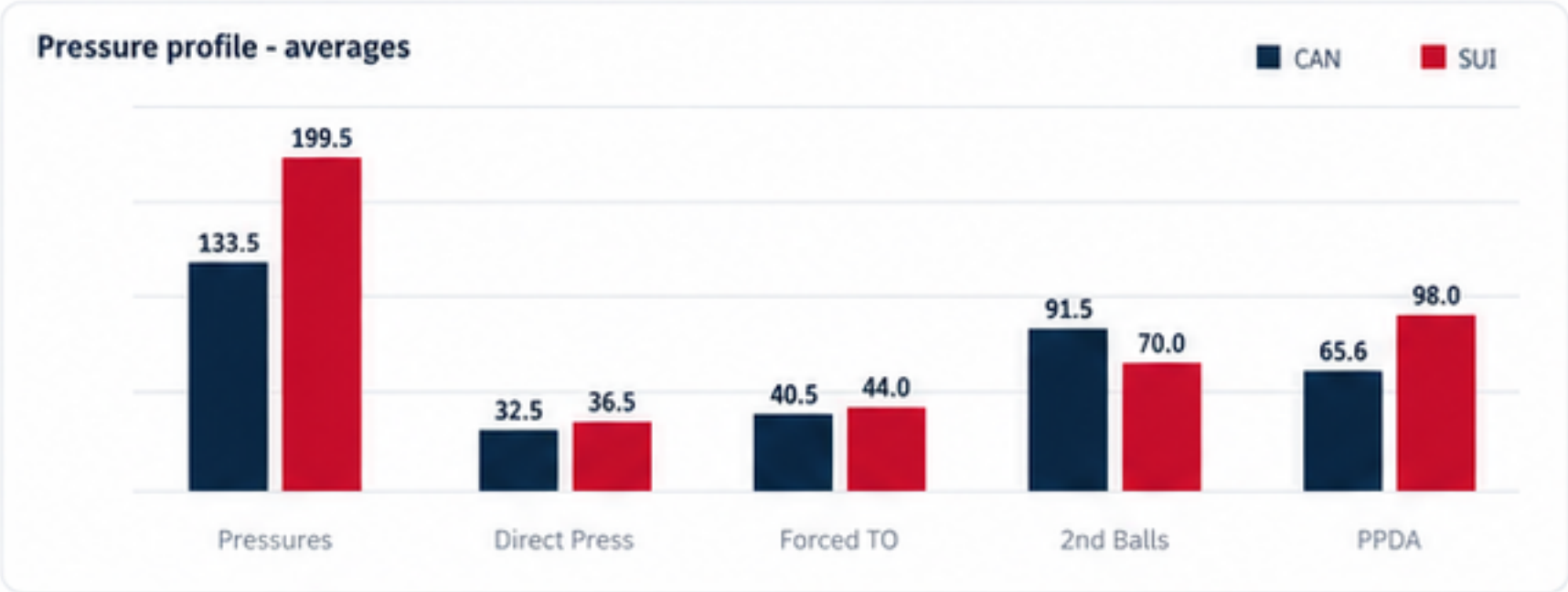
118
SWISS LINE BREAKS
PMSR avg

92
CANADA 2ND BALLS
PMSR avg

46
CANADA CROSSES
PMSR avg

PRESSING & DEFENSIVE CONTEST DATA

Statistical view of pressure, turnovers, duels and second-ball control.



* PPDA scaled x10 for chart balance.

Metric	Canada WC avg	Switzerland WC avg
PPDA	6.56	9.79
Recoveries	90	78
High recoveries	30	17
Def. duels won	18/32	23/37
Aerial won	20/48	12/21

CANADA DEFENSIVE PRIORITIES

- Press selectively: Switzerland can pass through loose pressure, but their first forward pass can still be delayed.
- Track Xhaka/Freuler rhythm without opening Manzambi pockets between lines.
- Win the second ball after forced wide service; avoid central clearances into Swiss midfield.

ESCAPE ROUTES UNDER PRESSURE

- Use Eustaquio/Saliba as first-support outlets; avoid blind central passes into the Swiss screen.
- Switch early into Buchanan/Laryea channels when Switzerland compress the ball side.
- David/Larin must secure initial contact and keep Canada connected to second balls.



SWITZERLAND PRESSING INTENSITY

Switzerland press with purpose and verticality, aiming to force play wide and recover high. Expect quick rotations from the front line to trap and win turnovers in advanced zones.

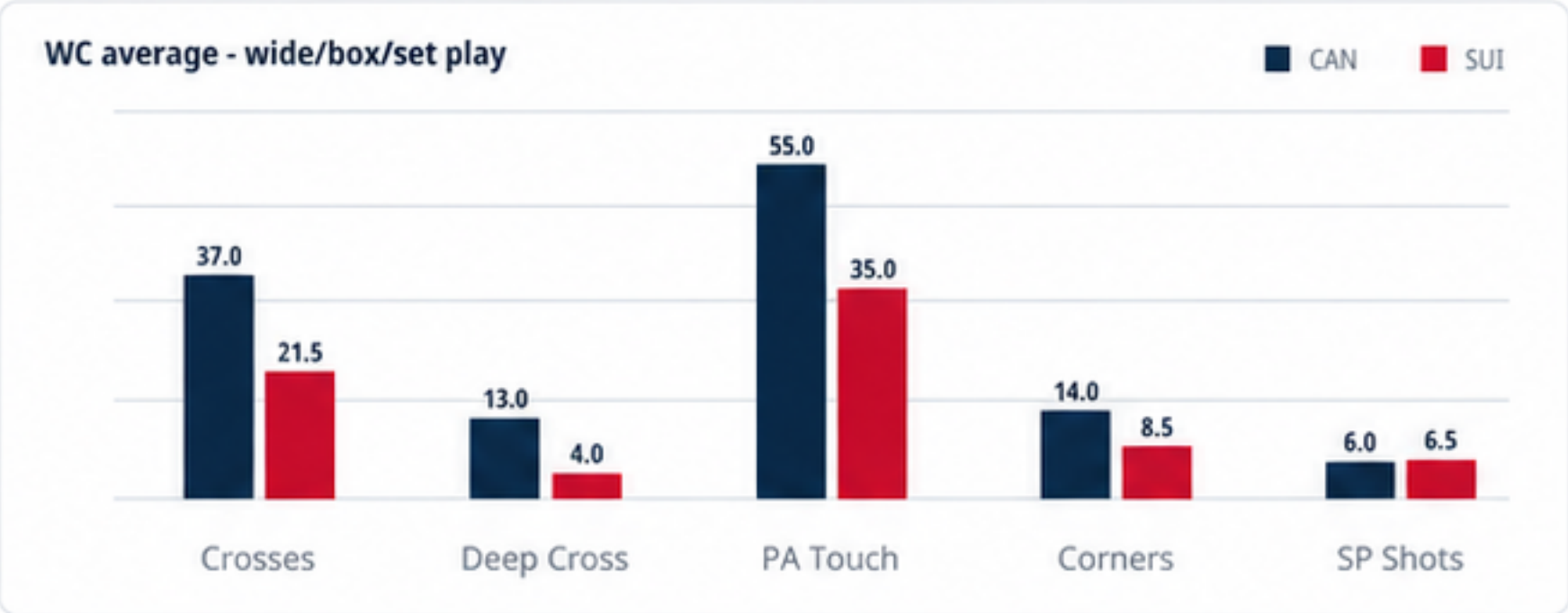


COMPACT RECOVERY & SECOND-BALL COUNTERPRESS

When the initial press is bypassed, Switzerland recover quickly into a compact mid-block and counterpress second balls aggressively to regain control and restart attacks. Canada must secure first contacts and manage the second phase under pressure.

WIDE SERVICE, BOX ENTRIES & SET PLAYS

Crosses, corners, touches in the penalty area and set-piece shot volume.



Team	Crosses	Deep cross	PA Touches	Corners	Set pieces	Set-p
Canada	37.0	13.0	55.0	14.0	33.5	6.0
Switzerland	21.5	4.0	35.0	8.5	28.0	6.5

CANADA BOX RULES

- Defend cutback lane first, then back-post runner.
- Clear second balls outside the box; do not give Switzerland repeat delivery.
- When Canada attack corners, hold transition security against Ndoye/Vargas outlets.

SET-PIECE / BOX READ

- Canada and Switzerland both generate set-piece shot volume: CAN 6.0 vs SUI 6.5 per WC match.
- Switzerland still carries a high box-touch profile: 35.0 penalty-area touches per WC match.
- Canada should attack set pieces but keep rest defence secure against immediate Swiss release.



WIDE SERVICE

Switzerland create width early and use switches or overlapping runs to deliver from wide areas. Quality of service varies, but volume is consistent.



BOX OCCUPATION

Switzerland commit numbers into the box in waves—front post, penalty spot and far post—creating constant pressure and overloads.



FAR-POST THREAT

Late runners target the far post frequently, especially when the first phase pulls defenders toward the ball side.



SECOND-PHASE SHOTS

If the first phase is cleared, Switzerland reset around the box and look to shoot quickly from the top of the area or cutback zones.

CANADA MATCH PLAN

Data-led match-day coaching sheet: what the numbers point toward.

1. OUT OF POSSESSION

- Deny Xhaka/Freuler first progression: Switzerland average 90% pass completion in PMSR WC sample.
- Keep central compactness before pressing wide; force lower-quality crosses rather than central entries.
- Track second-line runners once the ball reaches wide zones.

2. IN POSSESSION

- First pass after regain must be secure: Canada can use second-ball volume to connect attacks.
- Attack wide channels early through Buchanan/Laryea before Switzerland settle their block.
- Use David between lines and Larin as the pinning reference for crosses and second phases.

3. BOX & SET PLAYS

- Switzerland average 35 penalty-area touches in TeamStats WC sample.
- Own the six-yard line and cutback lane; do not defend only the first contact.
- Canada set-piece volume is strong: 14 corners and 6 set-piece shots per WC match in TeamStats.

4. KEY MATCHUPS

- Johnston/Buchanan vs Vargas/Rodriguez side management.
- Laryea/Ali Ahmed vs Ndoye/Widmer wide-space battle.
- Eustaquio/Saliba vs Xhaka/Freuler tempo and second-ball control.

MATCH PLAN IN ACTION



STAY COMPACT AGAINST WIDE SERVICE
Delay early crosses by keeping a narrow block.
Force play wide and manage crosses with numbers.



PROTECT THE BOX & SECOND ACTIONS
Defend the six-yard line and cutback lane.
Stay connected to deal with rebounds and late runners.



ATTACK QUICKLY WHEN CENTRAL SPACE OPENS
First pass after regain must break lines.
Use central combinations to commit and disrupt the block.

WINNING CONDITIONS

- 1 Central compactness
- 2 First pass after regain
- 3 Wide-speed release
- 4 Cutback-zone defending
- 5 Second-ball control